

The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter



Photograph: AFP

Donald Trump left **China** after a “successful visit that drew worldwide attention”. America’s president said both he and Xi Jinping shared “similar” feelings about how to end the war in Iran. Mr Xi, meanwhile, said the two-day “historic” [summit](#) would help establish a “strategic and stable relationship” between their countries. He said they would implement the “important consensus” reached, without providing more details.

Sir Keir Starmer, Britain’s prime minister, took stock after a day of potentially [irresistible pressure](#) on his leadership. **Andy Burnham**, Manchester’s mayor and Labour members’ preferred candidate to replace Sir Keir, found a seat to contest that might return him to Parliament (challengers must be an MP). Earlier **Angela Rayner**, a former deputy prime minister, was cleared of underpaying tax, paving the way for her possible leadership bid.

The director of the CIA visited **Cuba** to discuss “economic stability and security issues”. But the intelligence agency insisted America would only work with [Cuba](#) if it stopped being a “a safe haven for adversaries in the western hemisphere”. America also offered \$100m-worth of aid to the country to help tackle a fuel shortage, which America in no small part caused thanks to a blockade.

American officials settled a case against **Gautam Adani** over charges that he made false representations regarding Adani Green Energy, the renewables firm that his family runs. Mr Adani and his nephew agreed to pay \$18m to America's securities regulator. Meanwhile Bloomberg reported that the Justice Department will drop charges against the Indian billionaire in a [separate case](#). In exchange, Mr Adani has promised to invest \$10bn in America.

Mathew Wale was elected the prime minister of **Solomon Islands** by the country's parliament after his predecessor was ousted by a no-confidence motion. The Solomon Islands has emerged as a battleground in the [geopolitical tussle](#) between America and China in the Pacific. In 2022 Mr Wale criticised a security deal his country signed with China. But he has since toned down that stance.

Russia launched hundreds of drones and missiles at **Ukraine**, killing at least 12 people and injuring dozens more. It is the largest sustained attack since the war began: more than 1,500 drones were fired between Wednesday and Thursday, according to Volodymyr Zelensky, Ukraine's president. It comes days after [Vladimir Putin](#), Russia's president, suggested the war was "coming to a close".

America's **Supreme Court** preserved telehealth access to **mifepristone**, [an abortion drug](#), for now, sending the case back to a lower court in Louisiana. Two conservative justices dissented. Challengers had sought to reinstate rules requiring doctors to prescribe the pill in person after a federal court in Louisiana, which has a near-total abortion ban, sided with them, prompting an appeal from drugmakers.

Figure of the day: 55%, the full-time employment rate for Americans who graduated in 2025 in the fields most exposed to AI, down from 70% in 2022. Read [our analysis](#) of whether the technology is putting graduates out of work.

Is Britain ungovernable? On [a new episode of Insider](#) our journalists make sense of the chaos in Westminster, explain why Britain can't seem to keep a prime minister and ask whether centrist politics has a future.



Photograph: Alamy

Regime change at the Fed

A high-stakes transition is under way at America's Federal Reserve. On Friday [Kevin Warsh](#) replaces Jerome Powell as chair of the world's most powerful central bank. Donald Trump has repeatedly demanded lower interest rates, raising fears about the Fed's independence. Mr Warsh secured the nomination in part by bending his hawkish stance closer to that of the dove-in-chief at the White House.

But the Fed's credibility may endure. Mr Warsh's ideas for "regime change" have proved less radical than feared. They focus on shrinking the Fed's balance-sheet, overhauling its communications and broadening the use of alternative data sources. Meanwhile higher inflation, caused by the war in Iran, has weakened the case for rate cuts. In April Scott Bessent, the treasury secretary, offered Mr Warsh political cover by urging the Fed to "wait and see" before cutting. Can Mr Warsh withstand the fury of the president? His first policy meeting is in June. Investors will be watching closely.



Photograph: Getty Images

Palestinians mourn the Nakba

On Friday Palestinians commemorate the Nakba, the mass displacement and dispossession that accompanied Israel's creation in 1948. For many, that war never ended. Israel's right-wing government is entrenching its occupation of the West Bank; its army controls most of [Gaza](#). Materials to rebuild the enclave are barred. Ministers openly muse about evicting Palestinians who remain.

In decades past Palestinians looked to Fatah, a dominant nationalist group, for liberation. But under Mahmoud Abbas, the Palestinian Authority's 90-year-old president, the movement is sclerotic and powerless. After five years of delay, Fatah is choosing a new governing body from Thursday to Saturday. Few expect renewal: most delegates owe their positions to Mr Abbas. They are gathering in four cities, highlighting Palestinians' fragmentation.

Marches are expected in Jerusalem's Old City, the Palestinians' putative capital. But they will be led by Jewish nationalists celebrating Israel's conquest of Arab East Jerusalem in 1967. Palestinians mourning the Nakba there are likely to do so in silence.



Photograph: Getty Images

The energy shock hits India

India has been among the countries worst affected by the Gulf war, and things are deteriorating still. This week Narendra Modi asked Indians to work from home and forgo foreign travel to conserve fuel. On Friday the prime minister travels to the United Arab Emirates for talks that could [alleviate the pain](#). India is expected to sign deals to lock in supplies of liquefied petroleum gas, which is used for cooking, and to bolster its strategic oil reserves.

That may eventually provide relief, but more pressing concerns loom. The rupee sank to a record low against the dollar this week, making crude imports—which account for around 90% of India's consumption—costlier still. After weeks of absorbing that cost, state-owned energy firms raised petrol and diesel prices on Friday for the first time since the war began. Mr Modi has called for austerity from the public; now his government may need some of its own.



Photograph: Disney Plus

“Rivals” is smutty, sexist, snobbish and superb

“Rivals”, a smash-hit bonkbuster based on stories by the late [Dame Jilly Cooper](#), returns to streaming services for a second season on Friday. In the finale of the first, Tony Baddingham, a villainous media baron played deliciously by David Tennant, was knocked out with a statuette. He swiftly recovers to keep his end up—and get it away—in his continuing tussle with a thrusting television presenter (Aidan Turner) and a priapic toff (Alex Hassell).

Fans will be relieved to find the show’s formula unchanged. It still has a banging soundtrack to match its setting in the 1980s. Notionally the plot involves a battle over TV franchises, but again the real action is in the bedroom (and in a jacuzzi, on top of a piano, and so on). “Rivals” has the structure of a murder mystery—except the question is not who will be bumped off, but who will next bonk whom.



Illustration: Sandra Navarro

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each weekday. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and tell us the theme. Email your responses (and your home city and country) by 1700 BST on Friday to [\[email protected\]](#). We'll pick three winners at random and crown them on Saturday.

Friday: Which musician sang a duet with Stevie Wonder called “Ebony and Ivory”?

Thursday: Which famous physicist produced some of his most important work while employed at the Swiss patent office?

Forever is composed of nows.

Emily Dickinson